Prophets Sent, Prophets Ignored

1 Kings 19 · 2 Kings 17 · Amos 5 · Hosea 11

The big idea: After Carmel, Elijah wanted to die, and God met him gently: sleep, food, a low whisper, and a friend. Then God sent prophet after prophet, and the northern kingdom would not listen until Assyria swept it away. Finally God sent his Son.

Before you meet: Read

1 Kings 19:1–18 | 2 Kings 17:6–18 | Hebrews 1:1–2

Open (5 minutes)

Think of a time someone warned you about something and you did not listen. What happened?

Observe (fill in from the passage)

"And after the fire the sound of a low _____." *(1 Kings 19:12)*

"In these last days he has spoken to us by his _____." *(Hebrews 1:2)*

"Yet the LORD warned Israel and Judah by every _____ and every seer." *(2 Kings 17:13)*

Discuss

1. Right after his greatest victory, Elijah wanted to die. What does God's gentle care for him teach you about seasons of deep discouragement? *1 Kings 19:3–18*

2. God sent prophet after prophet, and Israel would not listen. Why is it so hard to hear warnings? *2 Kings 17:13–14*

3. Hebrews says God once spoke by the prophets but now has spoken by his Son. What changes if Jesus is God's final word to you? *Hebrews 1:1–2; Matthew 21:33–41*

Memory verse

"Long ago, at many times and in many ways, God spoke to our fathers by the prophets, but in these last days he has spoken to us by his Son."

Hebrews 1:1–2

Pray

Confess the places where you limp between two opinions. Thank God for his patience in sending prophet after prophet, and for keeping a people for himself by grace. Thank Jesus, God's final Word, who took the fire of judgment for sinners.

LEADER NOTES · WEEK 32

Prophets Sent, Prophets Ignored

Session plan (about 45 minutes)

5 min	Welcome, opening prayer, and the Open question.
10 min	Read 1 Kings 19:1–18 and 2 Kings 17:13–14 aloud together.
5 min	Observe: work through the fill-ins together. Use the answer key below.
20 min	Discuss: choose three of the questions.
5 min	Pray together. Introduce the memory verse and next week's reading (2 Kings 22–23 and 25, and Psalm 137).

Main points to land

1. God cared gently for his discouraged prophet and kept a remnant of seven thousand, chosen by grace (1 Kings 19:4–18; Romans 11:5).
2. God sent prophet after prophet, but Israel would not listen, and Assyria destroyed the north in 722 BC (2 Kings 17:6, 13–14).
3. Finally God sent his Son. Jesus is the final Prophet, God's last word, who took the fire of judgment on himself (Hebrews 1:1–2; Matthew 21:37).

Core doctrine to teach

Repentance CORE DOCTRINE 16 OF 26

Repentance is turning from sin to God. It is more than feeling sorry, and it is itself a gift of God's grace (Acts 11:18), not a payment for his mercy. It means seeing your sin as God sees it, grieving over it, trusting his mercy in Christ, and turning to a new way of life. The prophets called Israel to it again and again, and Jesus calls us to it today. *Joel 2:12–13; Isaiah 55:6–7; Luke 15:20; Acts 3:19; 2 Corinthians 7:10*

Answer key (Observe)

1. whisper
2. Son
3. prophet

Questions people will ask

Is it wrong for a Christian to feel like Elijah, wanting to die?

Elijah was a man of great faith, and he still prayed to die. God did not shame him. He gave him sleep, food, his presence, and a friend. Treat this question gently. Encourage anyone who has felt this way to tell a pastor, a friend, or a doctor, and in the U.S. to call or text 988.

Closing prayer

Father, you did not walk away from your people. You sent prophet after prophet, and in these last days you have spoken to us by your Son. Forgive us for limping between two opinions. Care for the weary among us as you cared for Elijah. Help us listen to Jesus, your final Word, who took the fire of judgment for us. The LORD, he is God. Amen.